Supplier Performance Review

Annual Scorecard and Root Cause Analysis: NorthPack Foods

10 suppliers   774 deliveries   January to December 2024

Prepared by	Simran Saran, Supply Chain Analyst
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Facility	NorthPack Foods: fictional Canadian food manufacturer
Suppliers assessed	10 across raw ingredients, packaging, and additives
Deliveries tracked	774 across 12 months
Scoring model	Weighted composite: OTD 35%, Defect Rate 30%, Documentation 20%, Lead Time 15%
Approved	3 suppliers scoring 80 or above
Watch List	4 suppliers scoring 60 to 79
At Risk	3 suppliers scoring below 60 representing 31% of total spend

Where This Came From

I worked in shipping and receiving at Agropur. You learn quickly which suppliers you can count on and which ones you build buffer time around. You develop an instinct for it. But instinct is not a corrective action request. It is not a supplier audit. It is not a formal performance improvement plan.

This project is the system that would have turned that instinct into something actionable. A weighted scorecard, a root cause analysis for the worst performers, and a corrective action plan that gives procurement something concrete to bring into a supplier meeting.

> **31% of total purchase spend is with suppliers classified as At Risk. A disruption from any one of them directly affects production capacity. Identifying this concentration of risk is the most important output of this review.**

Why These Four Dimensions and Why These Weights

A scorecard is only as useful as the assumptions behind it. Equal weighting across dimensions would be the easiest choice but it would not reflect how supplier failures actually affect the business.

On-time delivery carries 35% of the score because in food manufacturing a late delivery does not cause a delay. It causes a production line to stop. Every hour of downtime has a direct cost in lost output and labour.

Defect rate carries 30% because a quality failure in a food ingredient is not just a rework problem. It is a food safety risk. A batch of product made with a defective ingredient may need to be destroyed entirely. The cost is orders of magnitude higher than the cost of a late delivery.

Documentation compliance carries 20% because missing certificates of analysis, delivery notes, and origin documentation create regulatory risk under CFIA requirements. A traceability gap during an audit or a recall is a serious business event.

Lead time consistency carries 15% because a supplier whose lead time varies unpredictably forces the buyer to carry more safety stock than necessary. Even if deliveries eventually arrive the planning uncertainty has a real cost.

The Scorecard

Supplier	Category	Vol %	OTD %	Defect %	Doc %	Score	Status
Atlantic Seafood Supply	Raw Ingredients	7%	63.9%	5.07%	72.1%	**45.0**	**At Risk**
Maple Packaging Ltd.	Packaging	14%	61.3%	5.01%	70.4%	**45.9**	**At Risk**
Ontario Fresh Produce	Raw Ingredients	10%	67.4%	4.60%	76.2%	**51.1**	**At Risk**
Northern Flavours Ltd.	Additives	9%	86.4%	2.34%	85.3%	**75.5**	**Watch List**
EcoBox Solutions	Packaging	6%	84.9%	2.27%	83.7%	**76.6**	**Watch List**
Great Lakes Dairy Supply	Raw Ingredients	12%	85.3%	2.22%	84.1%	**77.0**	**Watch List**
ClearSeal Packaging	Packaging	8%	84.6%	2.20%	83.2%	**77.0**	**Watch List**
Prairie Grain Co.	Raw Ingredients	18%	94.0%	0.82%	95.1%	**90.6**	**Approved**
Rocky Mountain Spices	Additives	7%	91.9%	0.81%	93.4%	**91.1**	**Approved**
Westcoast Oils Inc.	Raw Ingredients	9%	94.1%	0.80%	94.8%	**91.7**	**Approved**

What the Root Cause Analysis Found

Atlantic Seafood Supply: Score 45.0

On-time delivery rate of 63.9% is the lowest in the supplier base. Defect rate of 5.07% is six times the rate of the three approved suppliers. Documentation compliance at 72.1% means more than one in four deliveries arrives without complete paperwork which creates a traceability gap on every non-compliant shipment.

The 5 Whys analysis traced everything back to one structural problem. Deliveries are coordinated by a single person at the supplier with no documented backup process. When that person is sick, on leave, or otherwise unavailable the deliveries simply do not happen on schedule because nobody else knows how to manage the process. This is not a people problem. It is an operational design problem that the current supplier agreement does not address.

> Recommended action: Issue a formal corrective action request within 5 business days. Conduct an on-site operational audit within 30 days. Begin qualification of an alternative seafood supplier as contingency. Do not increase order volumes until the score reaches 70 or above.

Maple Packaging Ltd: Score 45.9

Maple Packaging is the second largest supplier by volume at 14% of spend. That makes its At Risk status particularly important to address. On-time delivery of 61.3% is the worst among all packaging suppliers. When a packaging material is late in a food manufacturing environment the production run that depends on it cannot proceed. The downstream cost of a packaging delay is significantly higher than the cost of a raw ingredient delay.

The 5 Whys analysis found that Maple Packaging changes its internal production run sequence to prioritise other customers without notifying NorthPack. When NorthPack orders fall back in the queue there is no early warning and no chance to adjust the production schedule in advance. The current supplier agreement has no change notification clause. Nobody ever required Maple to communicate schedule changes affecting NorthPack orders.

> Recommended action: Issue a performance improvement notice. Renegotiate the supplier agreement within 30 days to include a 48-hour advance notification requirement for any schedule change affecting NorthPack orders. Require weekly delivery forecasts for the following two weeks.

Ontario Fresh Produce: Score 51.1

Ontario Fresh Produce has a defect rate of 4.60% that is concentrated in warmer months — a pattern that points to cold chain management problems during summer transit rather than a consistent quality control failure. On-time delivery at 67.4% is below the 85% target but is the best of the three At Risk suppliers.

The 5 Whys analysis found that temperature logging during transit is not automated. Drivers record cold chain data manually on paper logs. Without continuous monitoring data the supplier cannot identify or investigate the root cause of temperature excursions that lead to defective produce on arrival.

Corrective Action Plan

Supplier	Action	Owner	Timeline	What success looks like
Atlantic Seafood Supply	Issue corrective action request. Conduct on-site audit. Begin alternative supplier qualification.	Procurement Manager	30 days	OTD rate above 75% within 90 days of corrective action
Maple Packaging Ltd.	Issue performance improvement notice. Renegotiate agreement to include change notification clause and weekly forecast requirement.	Procurement Manager	14 days	OTD rate above 75% and defect rate below 3% within 90 days
Ontario Fresh Produce	Require automated temperature logging on all transit vehicles for NorthPack deliveries. Conduct cold chain process review at facility.	Quality Assurance	45 days	Defect rate below 2% within 90 days
All Watch List suppliers	Monthly performance review meeting. Formal improvement notice if score drops below 60 in any single month.	Supply Chain Analyst	Ongoing	Score maintained above 60 with upward trend toward 80

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Targeting	Supply Chain Analyst at PepsiCo, Maple Leaf, Saputo, Agropur
Series	The Case Files Day 14